

Beginners Guide to Alchemy

Magical Medicines and the Path of Plants



THE EMERALD TABLE

Truly, without deceit, certain, and most veritable.

That which is Below corresponds to that which is Above,
and that which is Above corresponds to that which is Below
to accomplish the miracles of the One Thing.

And just as all things come from this One Thing
through the meditation of One Mind,
so do all created things originate from this One Thing
through Transformation.

Its father is the Sun;
its mother the Moon.
The Wind carries it in its belly.
its nurse is the Earth.
It is the origin of all,
the consecration of the Universe.
its inherent Strength is perfected,
if it is turned into Earth.

Separate the Earth from Heaven,
the Subtle from the Gross,
gently and with great Ingenuity.
It rises from Earth to Heaven
and descends again to Earth,
thereby combining within its
the powers of both the Above and the Below.

Thus will you obtain the Glory of the Whole Universe.
All Obscurity will be clear to you.

This is the greatest Force of all powers,
because it overcomes every Subtle thing
and penetrates every Solid thing.

In this way was the Universe created.
From this will come many wondrous Applications,
because this is the Pattern.

Therefore am I called Thrice Greatest Hermes,
having all three parts of the wisdom of the Whole Universe.
Herein have I completely explained the Operation of the Sun.



Alchemical Meditation 2: Meeting your Guide In the Alchemical Garden

Imagine yourself as an Alchemist

You are dressed in the clothes and apparel of the Masters

From this imagined Alchemical self, Imagine a BETTER version. Everything about you is clearer and more defined, richer and more alive.

Now see yourself standing outside of an ornate Gate, leading, it seems, to an ornamental Garden. The gate is locked, but the ornate key is in the keyhole.

Above the gate are the words ‘*Solve Et Coagula*’- ‘*to seperate, (purify) and recombine*’. Stand and contemplate its meaning for a moment.

Unlock, and open the gate. Enter the Garden. It is ornate and beautiful, with hanging trellises full of roses, impeccably kept and neat bushes and hedges, perhaps even statues, fountains, paths and streams.

Find a Central meeting point, where three figures stand.

There is Thoth, the Egyptian, in Ibis headed form, holding the Unwound Caduceus Staff

There is a Winged Mercurius, holding intertwined Caduceus staff aloft. He has on a winged helmet, wears winged sandals, and has on a simple robe and cloak.

There is an bearded and elderly Hermes Trismegistus, dressed in the clothing of a Sage. He holds an *Astrolabe* in one hand.

One of these figures draws you in some unknown and magnetic way. This will be your guide in the Alchemical Planes.

Approach this figure and for now simply sense and feel their energy, and allow them to feel yours. If they wish to converse, do so.

Thank your Guide, and give a gentle bow to the other two Guides. They may appear to you as another guide sometime in the Future

Leave the way you came. Make sure to close and lock the gate behind you.

Alchemy by Numbers



One: The *Prima Materia*

'All Matter exists and originates only by virtue of a Force. We Must assume behind this Force is the existence of a conscious intelligent mind. This Mind is the matrix of all Matter'- Max Planck

The **ONE MIND**

Gives birth to the **ONE THING**- the source of ALL

Alchemists call this force the **Prima Materia**- the First, or 'Prime Material'.

It is the same as the Qabalists *Ain*, *Ain Soph* and *Ain Soph Aur*.

It is the same as *Shunyata*, or the *Void* of the Buddhists.

Through Desire, it gives birth to the Ten Thousand Things

Its true Name/nature/substance is concealed (A.E.Waite), much like the Tao that cannot be spoken of. A dictionary of Alchemical terms in 1612 gives more than 50 different ideas as to what this First Matter could be. A.E Waite lists 84.

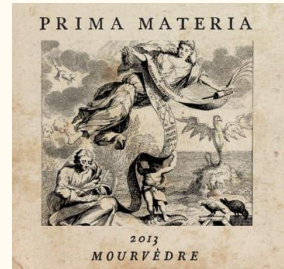
The First thing, or substance, or substratum, or Universal Matrix. God, The Universe, Urine, Blood, **Mercury**, lye, dew, lead, tin, vinegar, **Antinomy** (*stibium*), various planets, magnets, the **Stone** itself, **Chaos (Hyle)**, the **Elements**, and others have all been suggested as this primal matter.

Meditate deeply and long on what you think this **Prima Materia** may be.

I would say: Nature. Matter.

Also, Consciousness. Mind. **Nous**, plus **Energy**, the old Tantric equation.

But...also, various materials, including Urine. As a metaphor for Gold? As a metaphor for converting the impure to the pure? Maybe.



Two: The Twin Whirlings

The First Whirlings of Force and Desire within the *Prima Materia* gives birth to the TWIN forces of

Essential *Hyle*: The primitive formless base of all matter in/of the cosmos, according to the doctrines of Empedocles and Aristotle. This is also known as **Essential *Niter***. It is the ***Active Principle***

Essential *CHAOS*: The primitive base of all the ENERGY in the Universe. This force is also known as **Essential *SALT***. It is the ***Passive Principle***.

This is similar to the more familiar forces of Yin and Yang, from the Chinese Alchemy.

After separation, they give birth to...

Three: Stages

Stages of the '*Great Work*'- the '*Magnus Opus*.'

Can refer to the stages of individual Alchemical processes, as well as the 'Grand Arcanum'- or creation of the *Stone* itself.

Negredo: The Black Stage. Or '*Melanism*'

Putrefaction. Decomposition. *Calcination. Dissolution. Fermentation.*

Albedo: The White Stage. Or '*Leucosis*'. The stage of the washing away of the impurities brought to the surface by Negredo.

Rubedo: The Reddening. '*Iosis*'. Both *Gold* and the *Philosopher's Stone* were associated with the color red. The integration of the twin aspects of self, as well as the corresponding above and below.



Three- The **3 Essentials**: Salt, Sulphur and Mercury

The **Three Essentials**.

These are NOT the regular, smelly sulphur, liquid mercury or ordinary table salt!

These are the highest expression of energies in our Manifest Universe, and go to make up *ALL* BODIES, SOULS and SPIRITS in the Universe. All things are composed of these **3 Essentials**.

SALT is considered to be the Mortal **BODY** of a thing. When you die, your body (eventually turns into, what is essentially, a SALT.

SULPHUR is considered to be the **SOUL**, or **INDIVIDUAL ESSENCE** of a thing. In a *plant* the **SULPHUR** is considered to be its *essential oil*.

MERCURY is considered to be the **SPIRIT, ENERGY or LIFE-FORCE** of a thing. In a *plant* the SPIRIT is just that- **Ethyl Alcohol**, along with some water. When any plant is **FERMENTED**, it turns into (ethyl) alcohol. This is true of rye, barley, grapes, or your garden lawn. **Mercury**, called **Quicksilver** can be found seeping through mountain cracks or in small puddles in mountain grottoes. Can also be obtained by roasting **cinnabar- mercury sulphide**. The Taoists LOVED cinnabar for this reason!

Generally speaking the **SPIRIT** of any one **KINGDOM**- be it *plant, vegetable or mineral* is going to be the same.

So the **SPIRIT**, or **MERCURY** of all plants can be said to be ALCOHOL.

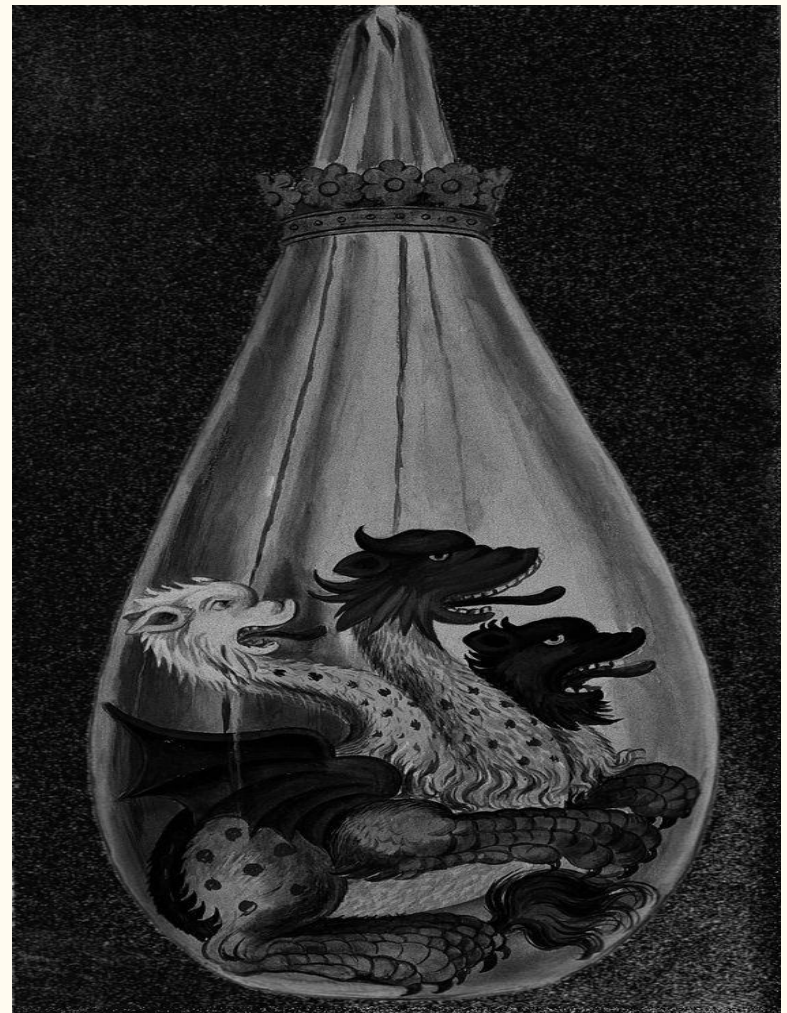
The very best ALCOHOL to use when making alchemical products is liquor produced from GRAPES. It needs to be of very high proof-190 % or higher. In the states you can use every alchemists favourite alcohol, EVERCLEAR for your experiments.



‘Splendor Solis’ 1582

Three : The 3 Essentials; Tria Prima

	Sulfur Soul Consciousness Oil
	Mercury Spirit Mind Liquor
	Salt Body Structured thought Alkaline Salt



‘ Three- Headed Monster: Splendour Solis- 1532’

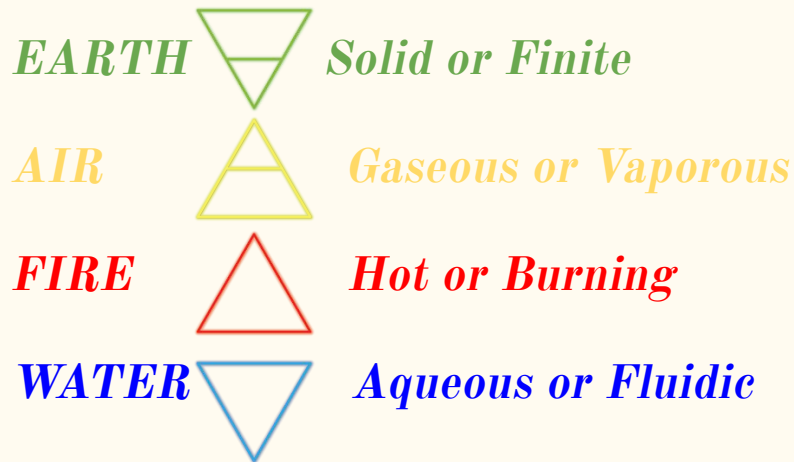
Four: The FOUR ELEMENTS

Sulphur is made up of *AIRY* and *FIERY* ELEMENTS

Mercury is made up of *WATERY* and *AIRY* ELEMENTS

Salt is made up of *WATERY* and *EARTHLY* ELEMENTS

Thus we have the **FOUR ELEMENTS:**



Alchemical Meditation: 3- the Four Elements

Enter your Alchemical Garden via the gate of '*Solve Et Coagula*' and meet your Guide.

Enter the central courtyard once again.

Now, four figures stand at the four sides of the square court.

They are brightly dressed in green, blue, yellow and red, and each has a jar upon their head, containing something.

These are the **Four Elements**.

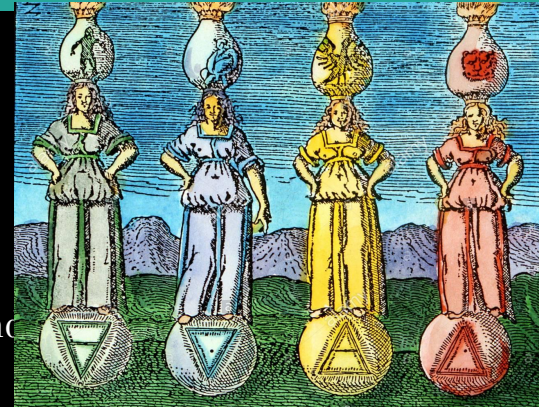
Ask your Guide which of these **Elements** most needs balancing within you.

Approach this figure. First simply take them in- the Raw

Power of the **Element** before you. Allow this energy to begin to harmonise and balance this same energy inside of you.

When you feel this **Element** harmonised within you, ask the figure what the jar upon their head contains, and ask how you may best work with it to more balance and honor this **Element** in your life.

Thank your **Element** and Guide, and leave the Garden, locking the gate behind you. Make sure to visit all the **Elements** in your own time.



Five- The **QUINTESSENCE**

From the Latin 'quintess', meaning 'fifth...and 'essence'

A symbolic name in Alchemy from the substance that the Four Elements arise from, and through 'Work and Prayer' can be purified, and returned to-EVOLVED.

It binds us, it holds us together. It is the FORCE of Star Wars.

It is **MahaKundalini**.

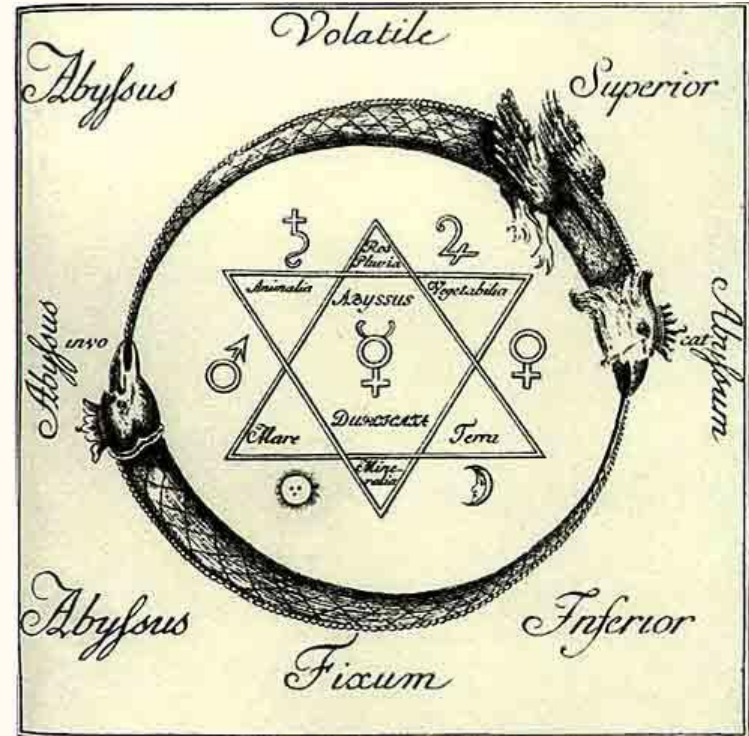
It is **Prakriti**- the 'Root' Energy.

It is **Akash**. It is **Ether**. It is **CONSCIOUSNESS ITSELF**.

In Alchemy, we seek it out, and through **TRANSMUTATION** we want to WAKE IT UP!



Six: The *Hexagram*- Union



Seven-7

The 7, refer to the 7 known planets of the Ancient world- namely the **Moon** (considered a planet here), **Mercury**, **Venus**, **Mars**, **Jupiter**, and Saturn.

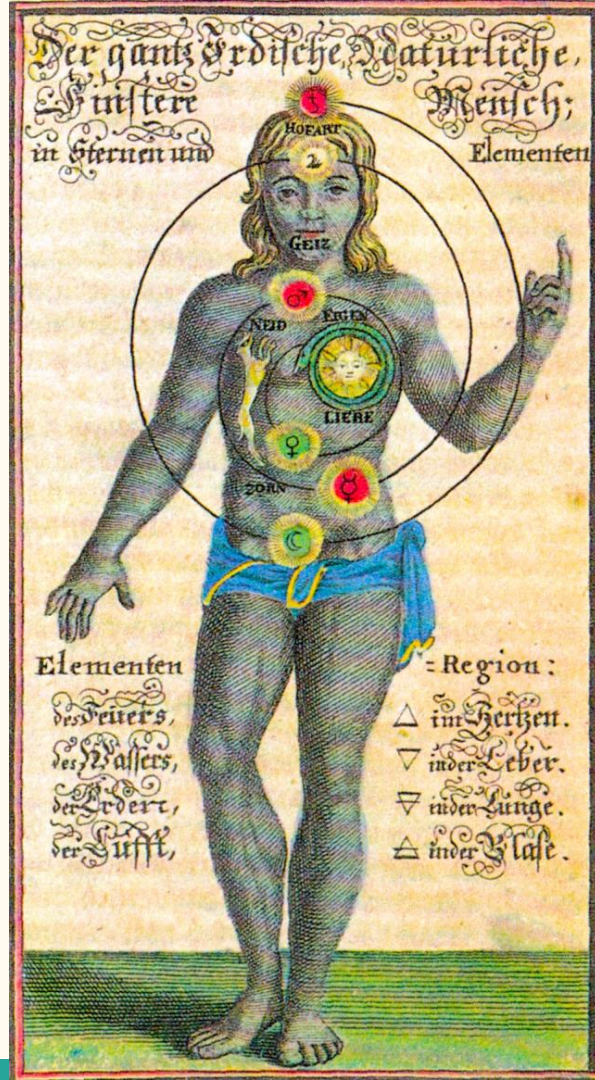
They refer also the the 7 Metals: **Silver**, **Mercury**, **Copper**, **Iron**, **Tin** and Lead

Also, 7 *Stars* or *Chakras*: Saturn/Lead (base), **Jupiter/Tin** (sacral), **Mars/Iron** (Solar Plexus), **Venus/Copper** (Heart), **Mercury/Quicksilver** (Throat), **Moon/Silver** (Third Eye), **Sun/Gold** (Crown)

Please note not all alchemists follow the same pattern.

Some have **Gold** (Heart) and **Copper** (Sacral). Some follow the *descending order* on the *Tree of Life*, with **Saturn** at the crown...

Follow ONE system, and stick to it.



Seven: 'Hermetic' Principles

1. Mentalism. All is '**Nous**' or Mind. Panpsychism. Similar in many regards to Advaita Vedanta, Taoism or Buddhist hermeneutics.
2. Correspondence. All things in Nature correspond in some way with each other, and with the larger whole. Thus, kidney beans relate to the kidneys, and sunflowers to the Sun. This is best extrapolated through the '**Etz Chaim**', the Qabalistic **Tree of Life** that appear in many A.I. It relates everything in our universe to 1, or more, or ten spheres, emanations, or **Sephiroth**- like a giant filing cabinet of interrelationships on subtle and not so subtle levels.
3. Vibration. Everything in the universe has its own vibration, its own resonance, its own song. Ultimately leading to the Harmony of the Spheres. Good vibes, bad vibes, truth is, we *do* pick up on it, probably more than we know...Physicists might refer to this as 'atomic or molecular oscillation'. It's how quartz watches keep accurate time
4. Polarity. Same as yin/yang theory. All things come in complementary pairs in our universe. Remember how Paracelsus saw all things as being balanced? This is what he was referring too. Also, think (research) magnets, and specifically, toroids and toroidal fields. Much will be revealed.
5. Rhythm. In everything is manifested a measured motion. Like a pendulum, all things to and fro, The kybalion also states that the measure of the swing in one direction is always measured by its movement (swing) in the other direction. Meditate deeply on this.
6. Cause and Effect. Known in the East as **Karma**, devoid of any morality but physics. 'All things have an equal and opposite reaction'.
7. Gender. Controversial in today's gender-fluid times, the Ancients couldn't help but see things in this way. Its not to say there hasn't always been homosexuality or gender fluidity, just it wasn't the predominate thing the Alchemists saw when they looked at Nature. They saw Sun and Moon, Man and Woman, and how species reproduced, and felt it penetrated to the Heart of the All- in the same way as the Indian Tantrikas. Shiva/Shakti. Consciousness and Energy- and gendered. Consciousness as the male aspect, Energy as the female.

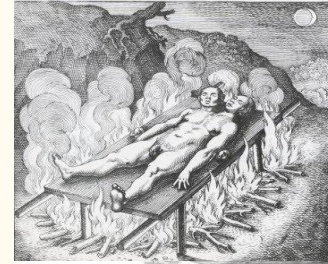
Seven: Alchemical Phases/ Processes

Calcination: ‘Give not up on **Calcination!**’. A deliberate reduction of materials to ash. A slow, gradual, burning away of impurities. A burning away of the **carbon**, the blackness until grey, or even white. Psychologically this is the humbling, the burning away of the Ego, the heavy, dark part of our natures through the **fire** of Alchemical prayer, study and **Practice**. One can say this happens naturally, as a process of life itself (to some extent), but there is no doubt we can ‘quicken’ this process and ‘burn’ our karma much more quickly through the principle of Ora Et Labora.

Dissolution Dissolving of the ashes- our **Earth**, and potential **Salt** of calcination, in **Distilled Water**. Here, our **Salt** lies in suspension in the **water** with its **Soluble** (can be dissolved in **water**) and it’s **Insoluble** (cannot be dissolved in **water**) parts. Represents psychologically the further breaking down of the psyche, by total immersion in the **Unconscious**, represented by **Water**.

Separation. The isolation of the components of dissolution by filtration, and the letting go of any unneeded or unwanted material, the ‘**dead head**’ or ‘**caput mortem**’. These are the insoluble aspects of our experiments- those we cannot, or do not want, to integrate. A conscious stage of deciding what to keep, or what to discard on a psychological level, and what to re-integrate into your newly forming personality/sphere

Conjunction. The re-combination of elements from our separation into a more evolved substance. Union of the Masculine and Feminine aspects of our being, or **material**. Psychologically, this brings about an integrated psyche, with all the powers of the male, rational, logical, as well as the female, intuitive, psychic.



Seven: Alchemical Phases/Processes

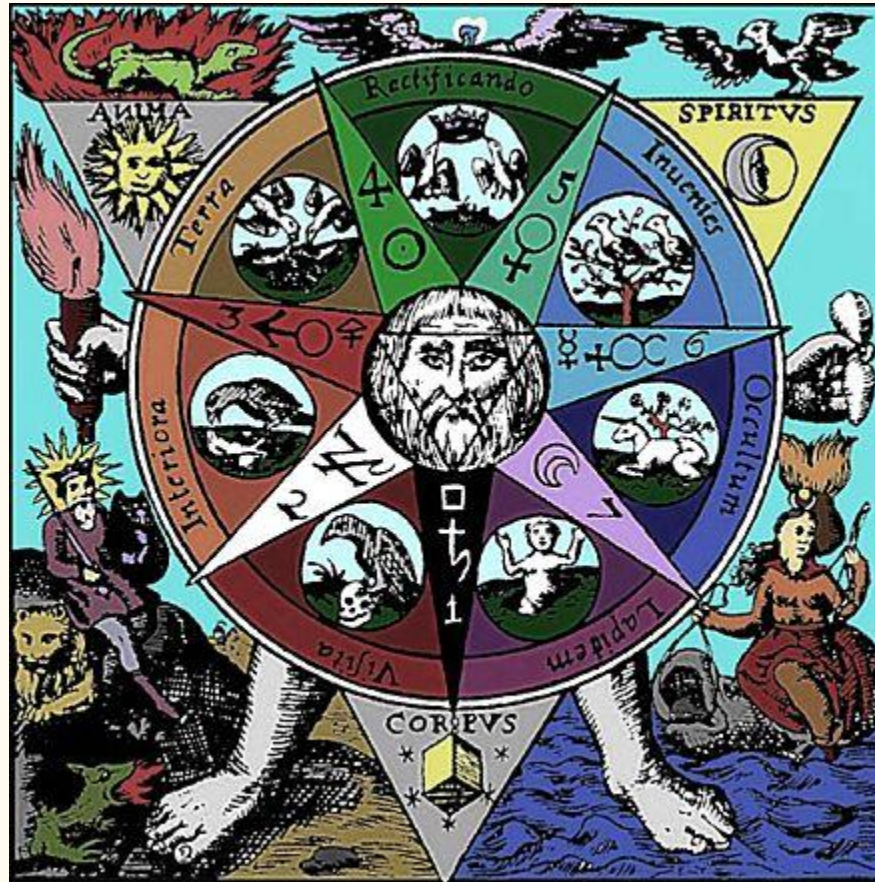
These four stages lead to completion of what the Alchemists refer to as '*The Lesser Stone*', and are all included in our Spagyric experiments. In my view, this lesser enlightenment can be gained within the Plant Kingdom, where we learn our Art.

The following three stages correspond to more complex works and experiments, and so won't be dealt with here, though we will be talking about *Distillation* later...

The final stages are:

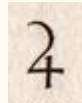
Fermentation,
Distillation,
Coagulation





‘Azoth of the Philosophers’, Basil Valentine 1659

Table of **Seven**: Correspondences- Metals, Planets etc



Gold

Silver

Copper

Iron

Tin

Mercury

Lead

Moon

Venus

Mars

Jupiter

Mercury

Saturn

Water

Herbalism

Dynamic power

Good health

Speech

Karma

Growth

Spagyrics

Violence

Philosophy and

Intellect

Minerals in the body

Fertility

Harmony

Warfare

spirituality

Magick

Learning and

Conception

Beauty

Arguments

Wealth

Alchemy

Wisdom

Emotion

Art

Psychic power

Ceremony

Qabalah

Teeth

Instinct

Poetry

Motion

Arteries

Astrology

Bones

Subconscious

Theatre

Power

Antibiotic functions

Math

Teeth

Rhythms and cycles

Design

Male sex organs

Cell growth

Chess

Teeth

Psychic phenomenon

Opposites into

Muscular system

General energy levels

Writing

Teeth

Collective

whole

Blood

and health

Communication

Teeth

consciousness

Perfumes

Purging body to

Enjoyment of life

Commerce

Teeth

Female organs

Skin

Blood formation

Liver

Initiation

Teeth

Fluids

Perspiration

Marrow

Assimilation of oxygen

Nerves

Teeth

Genetics

Sexual organs

Dexterity

Teeth

Cultural heritage

Speedy distribution of

Teeth

Brain

energy

Teeth

All bodily fluids

Nerves

Teeth

stomach

Mental skills

Teeth

Speech

Teeth

Hearng

Teeth

Growth

Teeth

Thyroid

Teeth

Important Principles



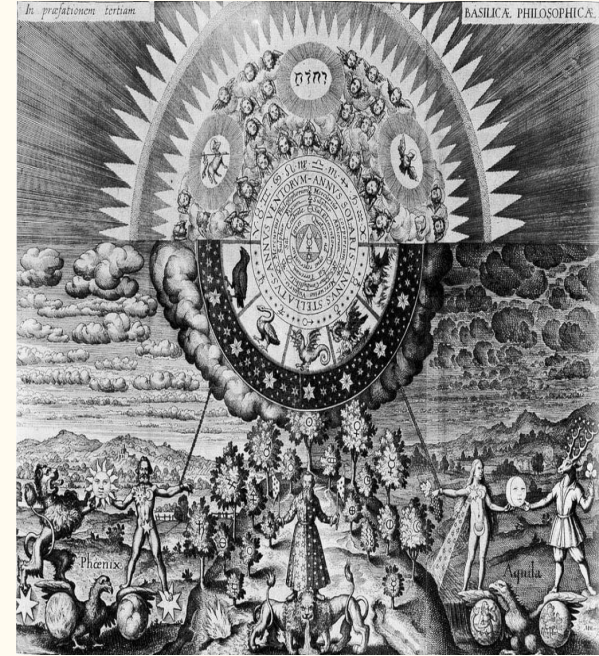
Azoth; the Universal Solvent
Basil Valentine 1659

Correspondence

The Mind of Man once thought thusly....

‘Melissa is not only in the garden, but also in the air and in the Heaven. Saturn is not only in the sky, but also deep in the Earth and the Ocean. What is iron, but Mars?’....

Culpepper, Qabalists and others go further, connecting, ultimately, All Things with All Things...this is especially useful in our study of Alchemical Medicines. Have a problem with the Heart? Take a plant associated with the Sun...



Solve Et Coagula- to 'Seperate and Recombine'

Originally, in Latin, 'to dissolve and coagulate'

The essence of Alchemy, in my view. We first find out what 'parts' go together to make up any material- the **3 essentials** and **four elements**, Interior Stars (or Chakras) in the Subtle Body, the aspects of psyche and Mind etc.

Then we take apart these components, purify them, and then re-introduce them.

Thus we have *evolved* this Material.



The *Philosophers Stone*

Said to transmute base metals into gold and to confer extraordinary medicinal powers, including immortality

Made famous by Nicolas Flamel (14c French Alchemist) and his wife, said to have been seen alive 300 years after its apparent creation...

White, red, black, and Rainbow Peacock *stones* can all be made.

Stones can be made in every **Kingdom- Plant, Animal, Metal, Mind.**

The *Stone* represents perfection and completion. The *Stone* ultimately represents the Enlightenment of the *Soul*.



‘*Ora Et Labora*’

‘*Pray, and Work.*’

There is no *True* Alchemy without both.

Ora can mean meditation, contemplation, confession, prayer.

To succeed in Alchemy, you must develop a *personal relationship* with that *you* call Deity. It's a *Spiritual Discipline*, and, amongst our beakers and our burners, we must never forget this. We are penetrating the heart of the Mysteries of the Universe with our experiments, and revealing the **One Mind**. It's difficult not to feel the presence of a Divine Creator when you get in that close. Develop this relationship and your Alchemy will turn all lead to Gold, as you see all Things as Emanations of the **One**.

The ‘**Work**’ is done in the Lab, and in the heart, mind and Soul.



Vitriol

‘Visita Interiora Terrae Rectificando Invenies Occultum Lapidem’

Visit the interior of the Earth by Rectification you will find the Hidden Stone

The dictionary defines ‘Rectification’ as ‘making something right’

Vitriol was the most important liquid in which other reactions took place.

Copper Sulphate- Distilled from a green oily substance found naturally from the weathering of sulfur bearing rocks and gravel. Symbolised as the ***Green Lion***.

Could be broken down to produce iron compounds, and most importantly, ***Sulphuric Acid***, a highly corrosive acid that the Alchemists could use to break down any metal- except **Gold**- hence the green lion trying to eat the sun- gold, and failing (bleeding). This is one reason they believed **Gold** to be the Purest metal- incorruptible, and therefore representative of the perfected Soul/Stone.



*"I am the true green and
Golden Lion without cares,
In me all the secrets of the
Philosophers are hidden."*

Alchemical Fire

“The Secret Fire of the Alchemists has been described by them as "The All in All," and, next to the solution of the Sophic salt, it is said to be the greatest difficulty in the whole art, Without knowledge of the Fire nothing can be attained, even if the Matter be known.”

IT is important we recognise the different aspects of the **FIRE** of the Alchemists.

It includes its Ultimate Divine Nature- the first **Yod** ‘**י**’ of the Holy **Tetragrammation** , the four letter Name of God, and represents the first emanation- **FIRE**. Actually, and interestingly, the whole of the Hebrew Alphabet, so significant in Qabalistic (most) Alchemy, is called ‘ the Alphabet of Flames’- each being a flame from that primordial **Yod** ‘**י**’, the Archetypal **First World** of the Qabalists and Alchemists- **ATZILUTH**- the World of **FIRE**.

There is the Creative Fire by which all things are formed via this Language, and there is the **Transmutation** that **Fire** brings

There is the **Solar** fire of the **Sun** bringing life, but also deserts and Death.

There are the purifying **Fires** of **Calcination**

There is the Sacrificial Fire we cast all impurity into, and offer up all that we can within.

There is the **Fire** of metabolism that fuels our inner transformation

There is **Elemental Fire** , ruled by **Djinn**, King of the **Salamanders** , magical creatures of **Fire**. They can be seen as lizard like, flame like beings within the **Astral Sight** of the Alchemist.

There is **Qi, Prana** or in Alchemy/Qabalah, **Ruach**- ultimately, the **‘Breath of God’** . The Alchemist transmits this via eyes, hands, touch etc.

Then, and most importantly, there is its Ultimate Manifestation as **MAHA KUNDALINI** , the **Fire Serpent**. In Western Alchemy this is called

The alchemists used an **Athanor** , a tall, round clay or brick oven, often referred to as the ‘House of the Chick’ to create a slow, steady heat over long periods of time



Meditation 4: Secret Fire

Approach and enter your Alchemical garden.

Ask your guide to take you to the furnace room.

Ask what must be burnt away in order to evolve. Cast this into the Athanor.

Thoth-Hermes stamps his right foot, once, and a beam of light enters your crown, brain, and shoots through the center of your being to the ground.

An enormous fire builds from beneath and rises up to your heart, where you find two triangles, interlocked- the hexagram

The upward facing triangle is made of fire

The downward facing triangle, water.

The Water disappears and you find yourself in a pyramid of fire

Around its base lies a Serpent, with its tail in its mouth

Feel the Fire as you intone the sacred syllables IAO

-EEEEEEE-AAAAAAAAAH-OHHHHHHHHHHHHH

At some point, the Serpent stirs, and rises. See through its eyes as it ascends your spine or central column to wherever it may.

See the serpent descend and re wrap its tail in its mouth.

Find yourself back in the furnace room. Then, leave the garden and close and lock the gate behind you.

Alchemical Symbolism



A Brief Guide to Understanding Alchemical Symbolism:1

Alchemy is full of strange, wonderful and often impenetrable images and symbols, to those uninitiated into its mysteries.

It includes Red Lions Eating the Sun, Dead Kings and Queens resurrected as Peacocks, Dragons, Serpents, Birds and a large menagerie of Creatures, both 'real' and 'imaginary'

We see images of Birds in Beakers and Skeletal figures rising from the grave. And lots of the images seem to merge into **EMBLEMS** and other even more confusing configurations.

What can/does it all mean? Well, certainly we don't have time to go into what it ALL means, that would take up a lot of books! But we can give some basic foundation in how to 'see' Alchemical images and make at least some sense out of them! First you need some very basic ideas and symbols...



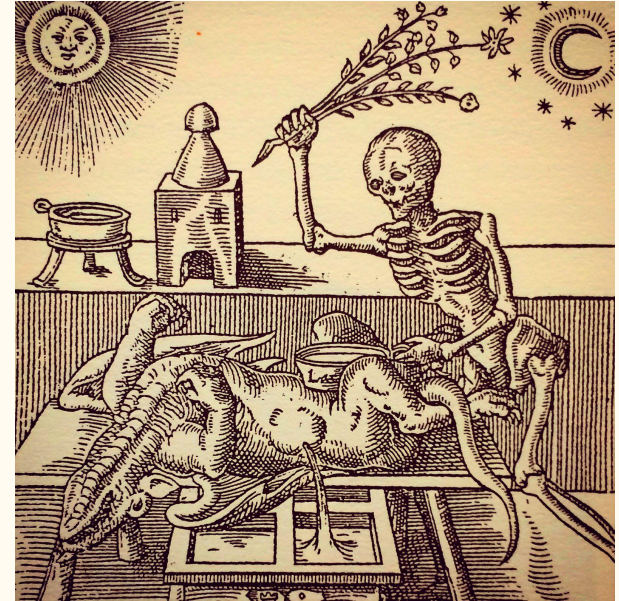
AS 2

Alchemical imagery is very often conveying **LABORATORY PROCESSES**.

Remember, this was a pretty preliterate time, and an image conveys a thousand words. As long as you knew what the images were referring too, you could follow the procedures and attain the practical results. And who would explain the images? The Master,

Unfortunately, and what a lot of people don't get, is that these were very often a LONG SERIES of woodcuts or drawings, and what has come down to us *isn't always complete, or even in order*.

Alchemical images are very often WELL out of context, in and it's therefore no wonder that no one can make head nor tail of the images. 1, 2, 3 or even 4 images make have only been a small part of a long and drawn out process. The images were essentially *lab-notes*, and *much may have been missing*.



AS 3

There are many types of signs and symbols found in Alchemy. Some, like these, are simple. It still needs to be remembered that this is essentially a *shorthand*, and may only refer to the notational system of a *singular* or *singular group* of alchemists. Its not to say there weren't at least *some* shared ideas, else we really couldn't understand ANY of it! These below are common enough to be considered 'general usage'



AS 4

3 Questions when looking at A.I. (Alchemical Imagery)

What images /symbols does it contain?

How do they relate to one another?

This can be a geometrical or positional arrangement, or may be allegorical or metaphorical. It may be practical, and technical, and represent stages, or processes.

Images merge together, too...

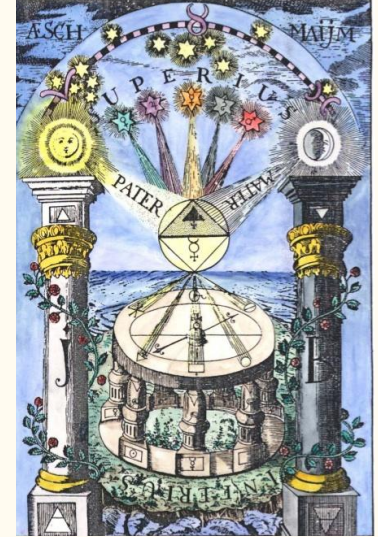
Unfortunately not even the same symbols mean the same thing to the same Alchemist! It's very often contextual, and depends on the **EMBLEM** (a COMPOSITE) in which it appears. Ugh!

Allegorical *Atalanta Fugiens* 1617



Left/Right Upper/Lower Arrangement.

Der Compass Der Weisen 1782



Process orientated

Occulta Philosophia 1613

AS 5

Where the image is found is important.

Frontas pieces (the front cover) were often very elaborate, to show the whole contents of the book as a sort of advertising, and don't really help when it comes to processes etc, but do tend to convey lots of 'big' Alchemical concepts/ cosmologies at once. These images appeared as the front pieces of numerous Alchemical texts- they were expensive to make, after all...

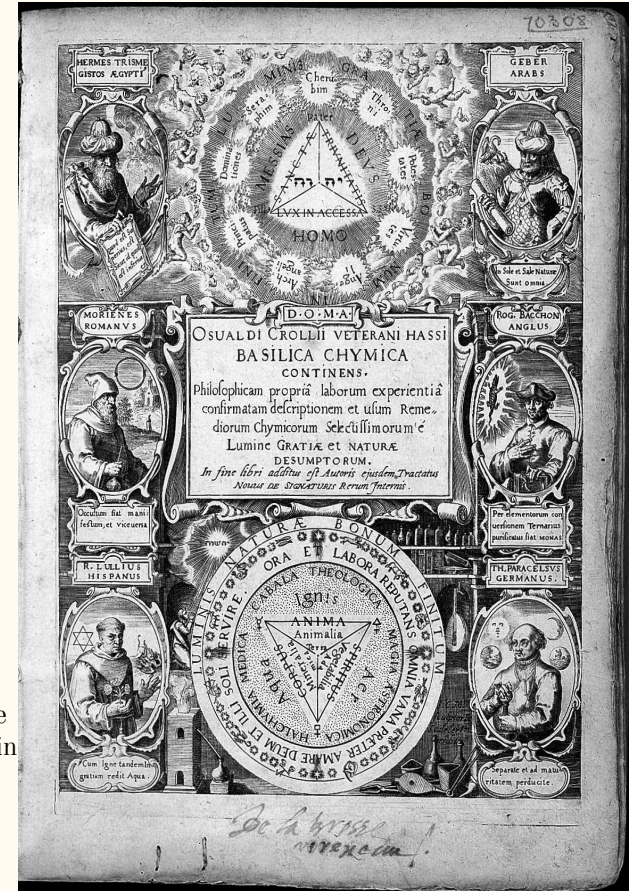
Small woodcut images such as these appeared throughout some texts. They were meant to just support the text in the same way a children's illustrator would. They weren't meant to be taken literally or symbolically, but just kind of...generally...

A lot of A.I are in *series*, or were meant to be. When taken out of series they don't mean much, if anything. In series, they v. often represent Alchemical processes going through stages of transmutation. 11 or 12 images were usually in each, and there are again, many repetitions of the same types of images in many alchemical texts.

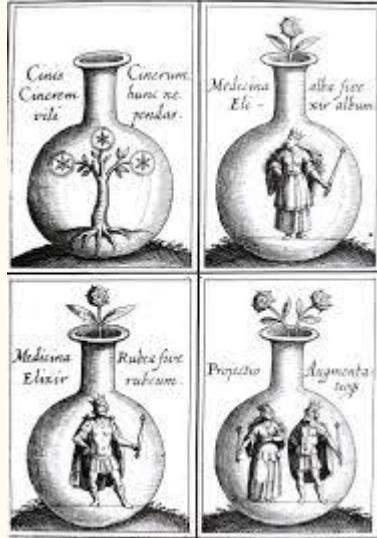
Until we know the source of an A.I, we must be wary of declaring it Alchemical...

Upper level shows the Celestial and Heavenly forces

Lower level shows how these Forces play out in the Material World.



AS 6: Examples of Similar Imagery



Circles- Unity, wholeness, completion. Symbolises '*Nous*'- the *One Mind* (of God). **Squares-** Matter and the *Four Elements*. **Triangles-** the 3 *Supernals* on the *Tree of Life*,

Essentials, other Trinities.

Angels: *sublimation or ascension* of *volatile* principle

Animals: The *four elements*- *Lion* or *Ox-Earth*, *Fish-Water*, *Eagles and flying birds-Air*, *Dragons and Salamanders- Fire*. (*Dragons also:* In flames- *Calcination*,

fighting- *Putrefication*, *with* wings- *Volatile*, *without* wings- *Fixed*. Green- 'Tamed' matter, and probably an acetate of lead, which comes from a green oil, Red-

Untamed matter, *Red Oil of Lead*, as the *Ouroboros*, the *dragon* eating its own tail- Saturn, and limitation/restriction

Birds-Ascending birds- *sublimation* of *volatilisation*. *Descending* birds, *condensation* and precipitation. *Both ascending and descending- Distillation*.

Crows- *Calcination*

Mountains- often represent the *Athanor*, the oven of the alchemist, or sometimes a hollow oak tree.

Basilisks- body of a dragon, head of a bird- represents melding of substances together, including our own higher and lower natures, as other co-joined beasts may also signify

Baths- the *Dissolution* process

Naked children- innocence of the Soul. If the child is crowned or clothed in purple, its the Stone- the union of the red king and the white queen. Crowns generally indicate

success in an alchemical operation, or perfection of metals and *magisteriums*

Doves- the Holy Spirit from Above. Signifies the change from the *Black* to the *White* stage.

Kings- Man, the *Solar Principle*, *Sulphur*. Usually, He starts out naked, and ends up clothed and crowned. When united with the Queen- *Conjunction*

Queens- Woman, *Lunar consciousness*, *Mercury*. She also usually starts out naked and ends up crowned and robed by the end of the sequence

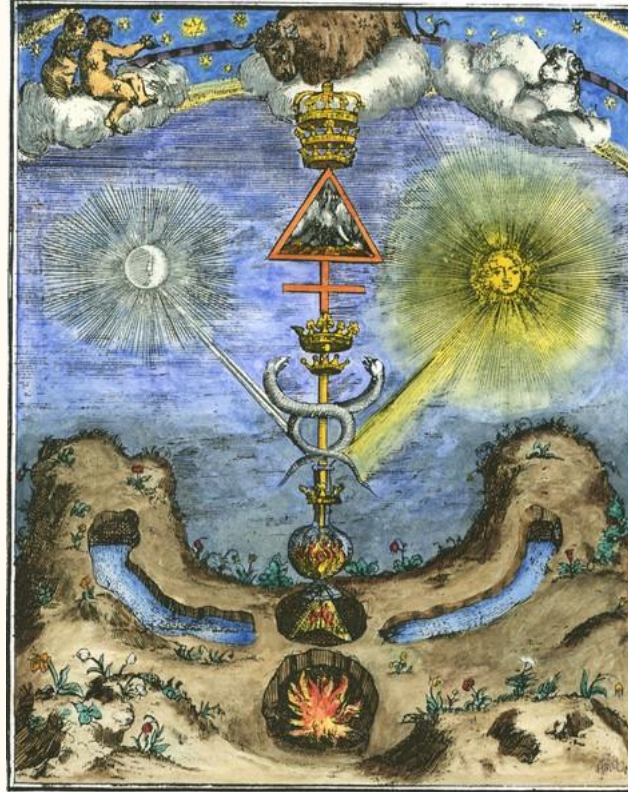
Lions- *Salt*. Red, white, green or black depending on levels of purification. Also, *Red Acetate of Lead*. Green- *Vitriol*. Winged- *Sublimated Salt* used to make the *Stone*.

Serpents- Masculine, Feminine aspects of the work. 3 Serpents stand for *Salt*, *Sulphur*, *Mercury*. Winged- *Volatile*. Unwinged- *Fixed*. Crucified- *Fixation of the Volatile*

Game- how many alchemical symbols in the following emblems?



Woodcut from Heinrich Jamsthaler's 'Viatorium Spagyricum,' Frankfurt, Germany, 1625.



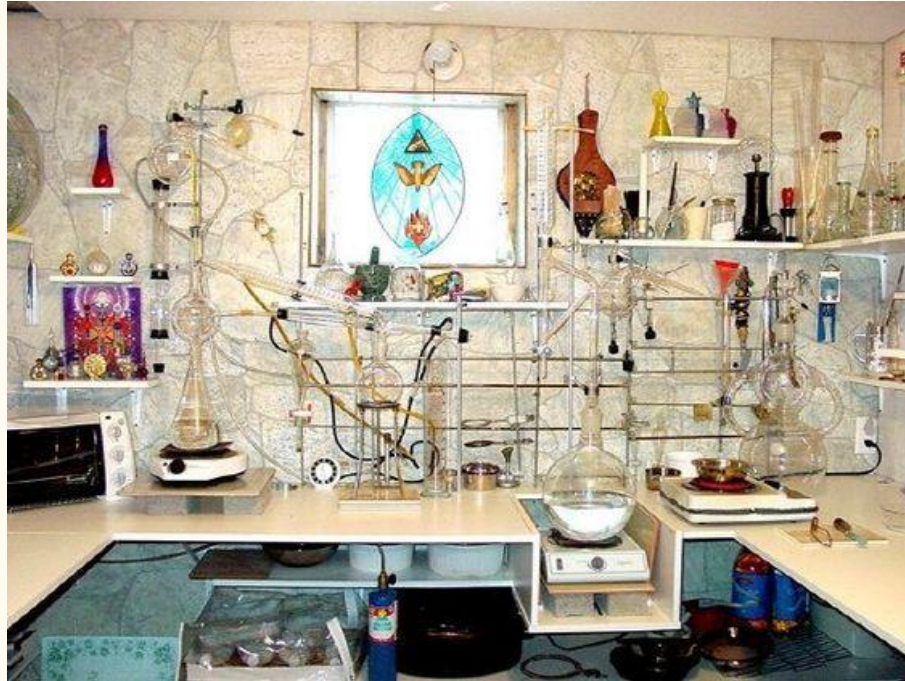
'Le Triomphe Hermetique', 1689



Labora

To work!

Where we get our modern word for laboratory.



The Inner and Outer Laboratory

‘ORA ET LABORA’- ‘TO PRAY AND WORK’

The Work takes place both externally, in the external laboratory, with beakers and burners and glass

And the Work takes place in the Inner Laboratory of the mind, the blood, the cells, the Consciousness of the Alchemist.

Both Eastern and Western Alchemy contain both Inner, and Outer work.

However, its true to say that Western Alchemy tended to focus more on the external laboratory processes, and the East tended to concentrate more on the Inner Processes (*Nei Dan*- Inner Alchemy)

In truth, however, we are, or should be ALWAYS WORKING BOTH, until we see THERE IS NO DIFFERENCE!

In practise, this means as we bubble, and boil, and grind, and burn our herbs, we must also FEEL THIS PROCESS OCCURRING WITHIN OURSELVES.

Likewise, we should realise, as we go about our lives, that the matrix on which it plays itself out is NONE OTHER THAN OUR OWN CONSCIOUSNESS, and that the people, situations and circumstances we find ourselves in are the TEST OF OUR ALCHEMICAL APTITUDE, and ATTITUDE.

Can we see the rising of internal anger as the burning off off the dross, as in Calcination? More will be explained.....

The outer Lab: 1. Essentials

Remember: You don't need a lot to start with & your lab can grow with you as you delve deeper into the world of Alchemy. As a beginner you can start with things you probably already have, or can easily buy. The following is a list of products you will need for your experiments with the 7 *Spagyrics* you will be making as part of this course, followed by a list of desirable, and not too expensive, and, thanks to amazon, easily obtained, 'extra' items. In this course, we aren't looking to build a full lab. Many of the mysteries of nature can be discovered with simple and easily obtained items. *Simple household salt*, for example, can yield many interesting mysteries...as can your own Urine that's another tale....

- **Clean, sterile jars.** Can use used, as long as you boil and clean thoroughly. Tightly fitting lids are important
- **Herbs.** See our "herb" section later. You'll need at least one ounce of 1 Herb for every day of the week (for this course) and, if you 'get into' *Spagyrics* and Alchemy, you'll probably end up with many more. Best, of course, is to *grow the herbs* you wish to use. This is powerful in and of itself, and ties you in even more deeply to the Alchemical process. Otherwise, you can buy. Organic is best. Find a trusted herb company to buy your herbs from. Not all are the same. You may use fresh or dry herbs in making your *Spagyrics*, but it's easier to start with dried herbs to begin.
- **Glass stirring rods.** May be purchased cheaply on Amazon.
- **1 big, non-aluminium pot, 1 smaller,** to fit inside for the purposes of *distilling water*. DO NOT DISTILL ALCOHOL without the proper equipment. Dangerous! See later slides and film for process.
- **180 Degree proof, or higher, potable alcohol** (drinkable- DO NOT use non-potable alcohol- the kind you buy at pharmacies. That stuff'll kill you. Or make you go blind. Literally.) In America, try 'EverClear'. If you cannot find a high enough percentage, use highest proof vodka, or, preferably brandy, that you can find. It's always preferable to use alcohol that originates from GRAPES, if possible. Even better, brew your own from the herb you are using. It's not that difficult a process- you can find some easy tuition online, and adds immensely to your Alchemical product....
- **Mortar and pestle.** Apart from its obvious absolutely necessary *practical* use, I guarantee you'll *feel like* an Alchemist the second you start using one! Even having one on your alter looks pretty darn Alchemical! Use stone over wood, and glass for finer herbs that might get caught in rougher stone. Wash and clean after every use. It's easy for herbs to get caught, even in glass.
- **Stainless Steel bowl** for *Calcining* your herbs.
- **An outdoor camping stove and 'hob' attachment,** again, for *calcining*.
- A heatproof glass dish for continuation of *Calcination* process.
- **Sarin wrap, Tin Foil, Masking Tape, Permanent markers.**
- **An Incubator/** Somewhere warm to **incubate** your *Spagyrics*.
-

The Outer Lab 2: Ooh, that would be nice....

- **Steam Distillation kit** (for distilling essential oils). The biggest flask you can afford. 1000mls is great to start. Don't be fooled into thinking you'll be bottling up and selling your own range of oils any time soon. Generally speaking, you get a *minute* amount of oil per distillation, depending on the plant used. That's why real Rose oil, for example is *100's of dollars a bottle*! Much better, you can make your own **hydrosols**- herb-oil infused, purified water. The **Art of Distillation** will teach you many interesting and essential things as an Alchemist. Start by distilling water, and then move onto herbs. DO NOT try to distill any type of resin, gum, or mineral in your simple distillation kit. Bad idea, If your kit has an oil separator all the better, if not, get one separately. Also, Alcohol. Whilst possible on a hotplate outside, I would still advise caution. Better to get a **copper still** set-up if you intend to distill alcohol at home.
- **An oil separator** if not in original kit.
- **A Soxhlet Extractor**. Now some of the old Alchemists wouldn't agree...but who doesn't love a 40 day **Spagyric** made in a *single day*? One of my favorite pieces of equipment, meaning I can make **Spagyric** products at home, within a matter of days, not weeks for my clients. Soxhlet extractors re-circulate the distilled material again and again back upon itself, fulfilling one line in the Emerald Tablet, right there...!
- **A Pelican**. These re-circulate at low temperatures your menstruum and material. A slow **distillation**, and **Circulation**. **Pelicans** are often seen in **Alchemical Imagery**...
- **Retorts** and **Alembics** and other fun glassware
- **Flasks**. Flat bottomed, and round. Big, and small.
- **Hotplates** and **Flask Heaters**
- **A Kiln or Furnace**- can be the small kind used for s/melting metals for jewellery
- **Crucibles** of various sizes



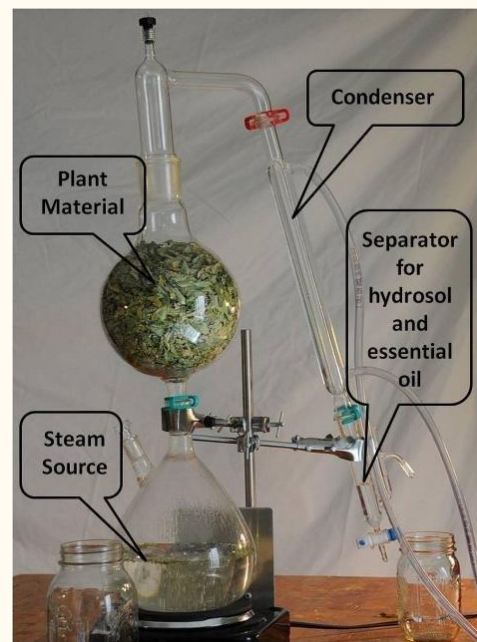
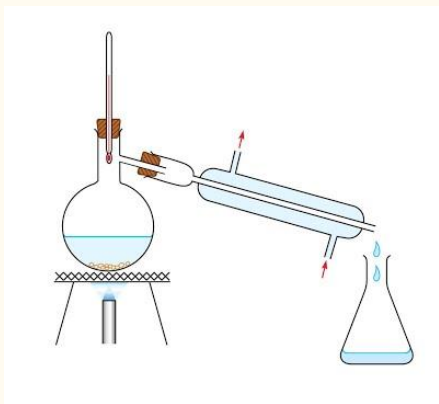
Distillation

Through **distillation**, we ‘separate the pure from the impure’.

The Alchemists were *very* interested in **Distillation**. (see John French ‘*The Art of Distillation*’ 1651) Many **A.I’s** are of **distillation** and different types of stills...

Set-ups can be simple or complex. We’ll show you how to do it on a stovetop, and follow some schematics and lab equipment pictures. You’ll easily grasp the idea. Think about it in reference to the ***Emerald Tablet*** and much will be revealed.





1



2



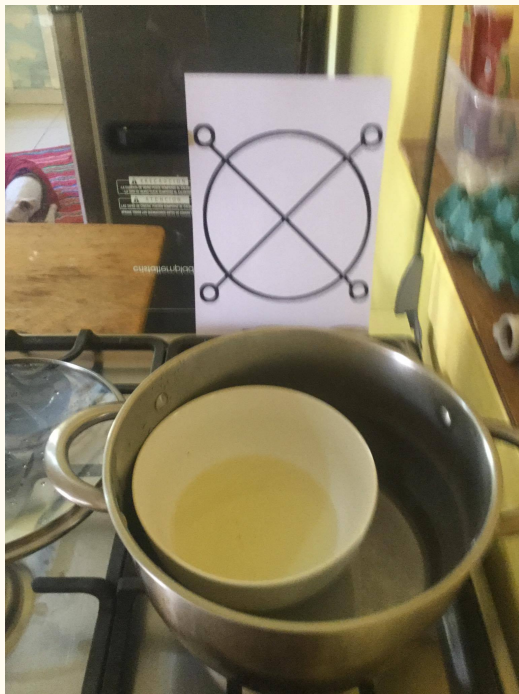
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Distilled Water + ***Salt*** Blessing 1

Make some ***distilled water*** on a Sunday, in the first hour after sunrise.

As you make the water, charge it with your eyes, hands and breath to be a *Holy Water*, capable of blessing and banishing.

On that Thursday, in the 8th hour after sunrise, go and buy some Basil, or if possible, some Hyssop. Soak it in the water as you recite the following conjuration:

Point your first two fingers at the Water, and where you see +, make the sign of an equal armed cross.

‘I conjure thee, oh Creature of Water, by the living Gods+ by the holy Gods+ by the omnipotent Gods+ that thou mayest be purified of all evil influence in the name of Elohim Savoth, lord of all Angels and men.’

Then, hold the flat of your hand over it as you recite:

‘Creature of Water, Adore thy Creator. In the name of God the Father+God the Mother+I consecrate thee to the service of the Most High.’

Leave the herbs in overnight, and filter the following morning. Store and save in a dark bottle, for now.

Distilled Water and *Salt* Blessing 2

That Friday, again, in the 8th hour after sunrise, buy a new earthenware pot, unglazed and a new container of salt.

Pour some of the salt into the pot and recite the following *conjunction* over it, and where you see a + sign, use your first two fingers to make the sign of an equal armed cross over it

‘I conjure thee, oh Creature of Earth, by the Living Gods + and by the Holy Gods+ and by the omnipotent Gods+ that thou mayest be purified of all evil influence in the name of Adonai, Lord of all Angels and Men

Use the flat of your hand as you recite: ‘Oh Creature of Earth, Adore thy Creator. In the Name of God the Father+ God the Mother+, I consecrate thee to the Service of the Most High.’

Gently and carefully pour the water over the salt. Recite the following

‘Lord of the Heavens above and Great Goddess Below, grant this salt will make for the health of the body and the water for the health of the soul.’

Pour more water as you recite

‘Grant that there may be banished from where they are used all powers of adversity and darkness. Let every artificie of evil be banished into the outer darkness by thy Holy Names’

Your *Holy Water* is now ready to banish, bless, cleanse and consecrate. Keep it in a dark bottle in a cool place.

Holy Water Blessing

‘Asperges me Domine hyssopo et mundabor: lavabis me et super nivem dealbabor’

‘Purge (Or wash) me with Hyssop (or Basil) Oh Lord. Bless me, and I shall be whiter than snow’

Spagyrics- To Separate and Recombine

In *Spagyrics*, we seek to:

Separate out the **THREE ESSENTIALS**; **SALT**, **SULPHUR AND MERCURY**

Purify them

Re-combine them

Co-habit and *incubate* them for a set period

Imbide them on the correct Day and Planetary Hour.



The Alchemy of Herbs: 1

‘Melissa is not only in the garden, but also in the air and in the Heaven. Saturn is not only in the sky, but also deep in the Earth and the Ocean. What is iron, but Mars?’....Paracelsus

Culpepper, Qabalists and others go further, connecting, ultimately, All Things with All Things...this is especially useful in our study of Alchemical Medicines. Have a problem with the Heart? Take a plant associated with the Sun....Here, we apply the Hermetic **Law of Correspondence**. *Correspondence is the attribute of a Magical or Alchemically inclined mind.* We can, of course, ‘learn’ these correspondences from long lists of boring tables and books (you’ll need to do this too, for sure. Try Stephen Skinners ‘Complete of Magicians Tables), but the best way to learn is by listening to the **Language of the Birds** or **The Green Language**. This is a metaphor for understanding the hidden language of nature and its relationships and correspondences by *direct apprehension and analogy*.

Be in Nature. This isn’t emphasised nearly enough in modern Alchemical texts, which, while it’s great to see a return to the lab, tends to neglect the origin and start of the experiments in some way- Nature herself. Remember, She appears as a guide with great regularity in [A.S.](#) Then, quieten your mind, listen and observe. Allow *assoications* to come to you. Does that mushroom look like a kidney? Maybe there is a relationship? That Sunflower...devoid of a name, what ‘Planet’ would it immediately make you think of? Does the smell of a particular flower arise for you? Might it therefore be connected to Venus? Does a plant prefer the ground, or the sky? Is it strong and sturdy, more...Martian? More neptunian or lunar?? Does it remind you of a part of the body? Does it only come out at certain times? What shape or colour are its leaves? Its roots? Its seeds?

Get to know your plants as friends and characters with attributes and personalities quite distinct from others. If you ever do plant *dietas* from the Shamanic Tradition, you will realise that Plants contain *enormous wisdom, power....and personality!* Actually, you WILL come to know this through Alchemy alone, but I know some of you may be aware of such training...

You., of course, have choice, when it comes to choosing the plants you work with. First, if possible, grow, or get to know the plant in its natural habitat. Nothing stands alone from its environment. Then, RESEARCH, and get to know the plants you intend to work with. Get to know them as you would any prospective friend or ally. Learn its LORE.

Second (or first!), know WHY you are choosing a certain plant. It’s not enough just that it’s a Monday herb and it’s a Monday. What properties are you looking to increase or decrease? What CHANGE do you wish to see come about? What aspect of yourself are you EVOLVING or ALCHEMISING?



The Alchemy of Herbs: 2

Don't worry if its an urban environment, either that you live in. Plenty of powerful herbs and medicines grow under foot all over, if you know where to look (and what for!) Get a good local herb guide to lead you.

Alternatively, and even better from an Alchemical perspective, GROW YOUR OWN herbs. To be involved in every aspect of the *Spagyric* process- growing the herb, making the *Mercury* out of that same plant, extracting its *sulphur* and its *Salts* from that same seed that you grew so long ago- this is powerful magick and a strong initiation into the workings and mysteries of Nature...

And if not, you can buy dried herbs from any number of reputable sellers. Get organic whenever possible. Fried herbs keep a long time if you store them correctly, but will eventually lose their *fire*. The closer to picking and drying you can get, the better.

The Alchemy of Herbs: 3- The Simple 7

Saturday: Saturn. Horsetail (*Equisetum arvense*). Stability. Spleen

Sunday: Sun. Eyebright (*Euphrasia officinalis*). Self Awareness. Heart

Monday: Moon. Watercress (*Nasturtium Officinale*). Psychic development. Brain.

Tuesday: Mars. Basil (*Ocimum basilicum*) Power/Energy. Gall bladder

Wednesday: Mercury. Fennel (*Foeniculum Vulgare*) Speech/ Communication.
Throat/ Thyroid Gland

Thursday: Jupiter. Lemon Balm (*Melissa officinalis*) Expansion/ Assimilation.
Stomach/ Lungs

Friday: Venus. Lady's Mantle (*Alchemilla Vulgaris*) Harmony/ Beauty. Kidneys/
Genitals

Alchemical/Planetary Altars for your Works.

Can be as simple or as complex as you like.

Can set up when preparing your **Spagyrics**, Can take down after, and re-set up when they are ready- or keep them up and begin the process of alignment and attunement, perhaps lighting a candle, saying the Orphic Hymn of the day etc.

Qabalistic if you like, Planetary otherwise.

- Correct Coloured cloth
- Coloured candles- all the way through
- Can have ‘correct’ number of candles, according to placement on **Tree of Life**
- Have pictures/images/sigils relating to the Planet or Sphere
- Have the ‘correct’ Tarot card
- Can use appropriate stones and crystals
- Use incense/oils/perfumes/fumigations associated with the Planet/Sphere etc
- Can use Orphic Hymns daily as you drink.
- Can play appropriate music according to Planet
- Visualise your **Alchemical Alembic**, your **AURA**, in the appropriate color as you work/prepare or when you contemplate/meditate and take your **Spagyric**.
- Concentrate upon the appropriate **Psychic center** or **Chakra** as you work and imbibe your **Spagyric**.

Spend time with your Altar/s. They can become powerful vortexes of Planetary power in your lives, even *without* the **Spagyrics**. With your potent potion acting as a powerful, magnetic, **Plant Talisman** for attracting, harmonising, increasing and balancing Planetary energies and Powers, it’s an incredibly powerful and transformative combination.

Times for Working: Natural Magick

Certain hours, days, months, astrological cycles and seasons are better for certain types of work.

Your general, most basic level is tying the herb/mineral/metal you are working with to the specific hour and day responsible for its spiritual essence or identity.

For example, the herb Mugwort (*Artemisia Vulgaris*) is aligned to the principles of the Moon. You can even see it right there, in the latin name for the herb. Artemis-, the Moon Goddess.

We won't go into why, for now, certain plants are aligned to the stars and planets, but just accept for now they are.

And we are trying to *capture* and *increase* this natural alignment of energy.

Thus, we work our herbs during certain hours, days, months and seasons that best exemplify, personify and activate/energise this relationship.

We may, of course, also choose to MINIMISE energies also, which would require the opposite.



Times for Working: The Moon

Our beloved satellite, the Moon, influences us and our Earth a LOT more than we realise.

Water signs, especially Cancers are particularly susceptible to its influence.

But, to a strong degree, we all are.

It controls the tides of oceans...think what it does to your blood, your own inner rhythms, flows and tides and moods.

In some schools, the Moon moves through 28 Mansions, or Stations, each with its own and different Occult influence.

We won't go there just yet.

We are interested, mainly in only two stages of our Moon's tides.

Is the Moon getting bigger- **WAXING**?

Or is the Moon getting smaller- **WANING**?

If our Work is for *increasing*, for *bringing to*, for *expanding*...use the **WAXING Moon**- as the Moon 'grows' in Size and Power, so does our Work.

If our work is for *reducing excess*, for *diminishing* or for *mitigation*... us the **WANING Moon**.

Times for Working: Planetary Hours

The best times for working when making your 7 *Spagyrics*.

This system follows the order of the ancient Chaldeans, who assigned hours of the day and night to the different planets and subsequent Gods/Spirits/Entities.

Monday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

Tuesday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

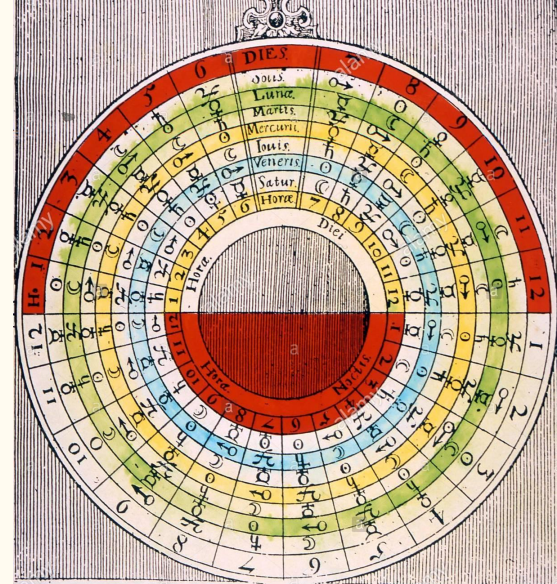
Wednesday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

Thursday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

Friday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

Saturday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise

Sunday: The first, 8th and 15th hour after Sunrise



Don't worry if you go over the hour- just make sure you START then.

Then, you can either simply continue...or wait until the next best *Planetary Hour* that day (8TH, OR 15TH) , or wait until the following week.

You can find *planetary hours* (say, a **Mercury** hour) on a non planetary days (say on a **Monday**) ...but that's another lesson.

Ora: Prayer

Thou One Only Thing,

The Vast and the Mighty One

Ruler of the Light, and the Darkness

We adore thee, and we Invoke Thee.

Look now with favor upon me

As I standeth Before Thee

And grant Thine aid, unto the highest aspirations of my Soul

That I may be enabled to accomplish the Great Work

To the Glory and Benefit of all Beings, Amen



A Simple *Spagyric* Process 1: Preparation

1. On the appropriate hour of the appropriate day, gather 1 ounce of clean, dry Herb.
2. On your Alchemical Alter, cut your Herb into small pieces, whilst reciting Orphic Hymn/Tantric Mantra/Planetary....(Burn appropriate incense, Play music appropriate to the Planet. Use Planetary glyphs, given in a later slide on and around your working area. Wear the color appropriate to the planet, if you wish)
3. Place your cut Herb into your **Mortar** and **Pestle** and grind as fine as possible
4. Place your Herb in a clean and sterilised glass jar
5. Slowly and carefully, pour in your alcohol until you have covered the herb, and then around 3 fingers widths ABOVE/OVER the herb.
6. As with all **Alchemical** and **Spagyric** Processes, remember to associate what is going on in your mortar and pestle, jars and such with what is going on INSIDE OF YOU.
7. Cover the top with Sarin wrap, and place back the lid, TIGHTLY. You are going to need to shake this jar on a daily basis. so...TIGHTLY!
8. Shake the jar for at least three minutes. Think about this separation of the 3 **ESSENTIALS** and, again, how they apply to YOU. Energise the jar with your own **ALCHEMICAL FIRE**, from your hands, eyes and, ultimately, Mind. Charge it with **Planetary Essence** channeled through your own being.
9. Cover the jar in tin foil and label it carefully. Do NOT rely on memory! You are going to have a lot of these at some point and will NOT know which is which without *correct and obvious labelling*. Use a permanent marker. A sample label is on the next slide.
10. **Incubate** in a warm place for at least a full **Alchemical Month**- 40 days- the longer you leave it, the stronger it will be.

A Simple *Spagyric* Process 2: *Fire*

1. Having incubated your herb for a full *Alchemical month* it is now ready for the next part of the process
2. Shake your herb on last time, with intention. Then carefully unscrew the top and remove the sarin wrap.
3. Filter the liquid and separate out the herb. It will still have some alcohol saturated into it, which is good. You may discard the '*Caput Mortem*'- the 'Dead Head' sludge at the bottom on the filter paper.
4. Next, in a heatproof pan, carefully, set light to the material. It will catch fast, be super hot and gives off a lot of smoke in the beginning.
5. After all the alcohol has burned away, light from beneath.
6. After a while, when much of the carbon/blackness has been burned off, take your ash and grind it in a mortar and pestle.
7. Reheat, stirring often.
8. Grind and repeat for some hours until your ash is v. light grey, or even white (if your lucky!)
9. Place in the oven at a medium temperature and leave overnight.

A Simple *Spagyric* Process 3: *Water*

1. Take your ash and dissolve it in ***Distilled Water*** (preferably made on the appropriate day, in the appropriate hour, but not strictly necessary)
2. Cover in Sarin wrap and tightly lid.
3. For the next few hours, up to a whole day, shake regularly.
4. Filter the liquid through coffee filter.
5. Filter Again.
6. Discard the ***Corpus Mortem***, the sludge on the coffee filter.
7. *Slowly* evaporate off the liquid, by placing in a warm place, such as on a coffee mug warmer.
8. You will notice a white ***Salt*** begin to form in your vessel. Don't be surprised if it doesn't look like much material. This is your ***Sal Salis***- the '***Salt of Salts***' of the Alchemists. It is very potent, sharp and has a 'penetrating' taste.
9. You may stop here, adding your ***Salt*** , by scraping it up with a razor blade, into your ***Spagyric***, or you may add further process in more advanced experiments.
10. Cover with Sarin wrap, lid, and shake. Your ***Spagyric*** is now ready to take, or you may wish to add a further week/month shaking daily. The ***Spagyric*** is now a potent, initiatory medicine that can align you to powerful planetary energies. Well done.

2 Ways to make Simple Incubators

1. A simple styrofoam box, with a thermometer (not strictly necessary) and a lightbulb. (Remember eggs, represent the Aura!)



1. Cut a hole in a corner for the lead
2. Coat bottom with perlite
3. Add Heating Mat to set temp and thread lead through hole
4. Add another inch or so of Perlite

Wear a mask when dealing with perlite.



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11



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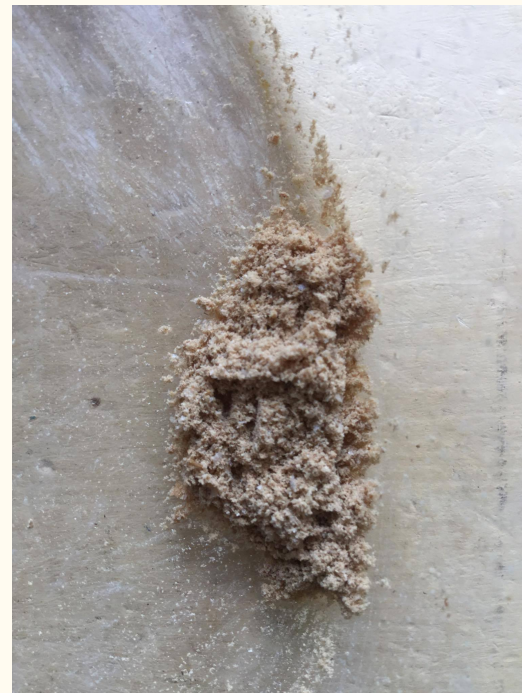
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17



18



How to take your 7 *Spagyrics*

In the correct Planetary Hour, on the correct day of the week, sit quietly for some moments, and if you have your alchemical altars set up, or have set one up, then meditate for a bit in front of your altar.

Contemplate the planet, and the qualities they represent. Think about those qualities inside of you, and see yourself changing, evolving and transforming those aspects of self that align with this herb and planets influence. See this sphere of your being becoming harmonised, balanced, improved, evolved.

Take your *Spagyric* in hand, and offering a prayer of thanks to the *One* for this Alchemical gift, take half to one teaspoon in water. Hold under your tongue. Be warned. It may burn a little. Add more water if necessary.

Hold under your tongue for around three minutes.

Swallow.

FEEL AND NOTICE THE CHANGE.

For simple health purposes, once or twice a day may be enough.

For INITIATORY purposes- to truly attune you to the energy, wisdom and knowledge of a particular Sphere (Planet)- take them 3 times a day, or even four if you can get up in the middle of the night....

Make sure the Herbs you have chosen are not toxic to the system when taken to this amount. If so, drop the amount, but keep the regimen.

Take the 7 on their respective days of the week for 1-3 months. Keep a diary of your dreams and experiences during this time.

Saturday: *Saturn*

ETHERIAL father, mighty Titan, hear,
Great fire of Gods and men, whom all revere:
Endu'd with various council, pure and strong,
To whom perfection and decrease belong.
Consum'd by thee all forms that hourly die,
By thee restor'd, their former place supply;
The world immense in everlasting chains,
Strong and ineffable thy pow'r contains
Father of vast eternity, divine,
O mighty Saturn, various speech is thine:
Blossom of earth and of the starry skies,
Husband of Rhea, and Prometheus wife.
Obstetric Nature, venerable root,
From which the various forms of being shoot;
No parts peculiar can thy pow'r enclose,
Diffus'd thro' all, from which the world arose,
O, best of beings, of a subtle mind,
Propitious hear to holy pray'rs inclin'd;
The sacred rites benevolent attend,
And grant a blameless life, a blessed end.

GLYPH:



CHAKRA: Base

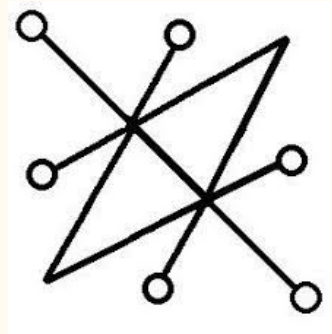
TAROT: The Universe

AURA: Black

CLOTH: Black

CANDLES: Black, 3

PLANETARY SEAL:



STONES: Obsidian, Smoky quartz, Onyx

MUSIC: Holst, The Planets, Saturn, bringer of Old Age

INCENSE: Myrrh, opoponax, sulphur and foul smells

Sun- Sunday

Hear, golden Titan, whose eternal eye
With matchless sight illumines all the sky.
Native, unwearied in diffusing light,
And to all eyes the object of delight:
Lord of the Seasons, beaming light from far,
Sonorous, dancing in thy four-yok'd car.
With thy right hand the source of morning
light,
And with thy left the father of the night.
Agile and vig'rous, venerable Sun,
Fiery and bright around the heav'ns you run,
Foe to the wicked, but the good man's guide,
O'er all his steps propitious you preside.
With various-sounding golden lyre 'tis thine
To fill the world with harmony divine.
Father of ages, guide of prosp'rous deeds,
The world's commander, borne by lucid
steeds.
Immortal Jove, flute-playing, bearing light,
Source of existence, pure and fiery bright;
Bearer of fruit, almighty lord of years,

Agile and warm, whom ev'ry power reveres.
Bright eye, that round the world incessant flies,
Doom'd with fair fulgid rays to set and rise;
Dispensing justice, lover of the stream,
The world's great master, and o'er all supreme.
Faithful defender, and the eye of right,
Of steeds the ruler, and of life the light:
With sounding whip four fiery steeds you guide,
When in the glittering car of day you ride,
Propitious on these mystic labours shine,
And bless thy suppliants with a life divine.

GLYPH:



Sol

AURA: Bright Golden

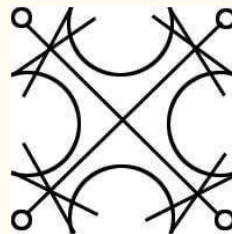
CHAKRA: Base

TAROT: The Sun

CLOTH: Gold

CANDLES: Gold, 6

PLANETARY SEAL:



MUSIC: Holst, The Planets, The Sun

STONES: Sunstone, Amber, Orange Calcite

INCENSE: Cinnamon, Frankincense, orange,

Moon- Monday

Hear, Goddess queen, diffusing silver light,
Bull-horn'd, and wand'ring thro' the gloom of Night.
With stars surrounded, and with circuit wide
Night's torch extending, through the heav'ns you ride:
Female and male, with silv'ry rays you shine,
And now full-orb'd, now tending to decline.
Mother of ages, fruit-producing Moon,
Whose amber orb makes Night's reflected noon:
Lover of horses, splendid queen of night,
All-seeing pow'r, bedeck'd with starry light,
Lover of vigilance, the foe of strife,
In peace rejoicing, and a prudent life:
Fair lamp of Night, its ornament and friend,
Who giv'st to Nature's works their destin'd end.
Queen of the stars, all-wise Diana, hail!
Deck'd with a graceful robe and ample veil.
Come, blessed Goddess, prudent, starry, bright,
Come, moony-lamp, with chaste and splendid light,
Shine on these sacred rites with prosp'rous rays,
And pleas'd accept thy suppliants' mystic praise.

GLYPH:



AURA: Violet

TAROT: The High Priestess

CHAKRA: Third eye

CLOTH: Silver, blue or violet

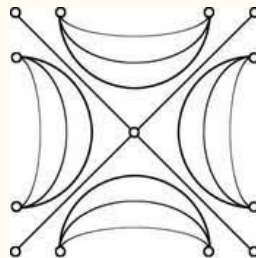
CANDLES: Silver, blue or violet. 9

STONES: Moonstone

METAL: Silver

PLANETARY SEAL:

INCENSE: Jasmine, lotus, almond,
white rose, vervain, verbena, myrrh,
sandalwood, white sage, mugwort, fennel,
artemia, garlic, orris root, white poppy,
wormwood poppy, and lavender.



Mars- Tuesday

Magnanimous, unconquer'd, boistrous Mars,
In darts rejoicing, and in bloody wars
Fierce and untam'd, whose mighty pow'r can
make
The strongest walls from their foundations shake:
Mortal destroying king, defil'd with gore,
Pleas'd with war's dreadful and tumultuous roar:
Thee, human blood, and swords, and spears
delight,
And the dire ruin of mad savage fight.
Stay, furious contests, and avenging strife,
Whose works with woe, embitter human life; 10
To lovely Venus, and to Bacchus yield,
To Ceres give the weapons of the field;
Encourage peace, to gentle works inclin'd,
And give abundance, with benignant mind.

GLYPH:



Mars

AURA: Red

TABLECLOTH: Red

CANDLES: Red, 6

MUSIC: Holst, Mars, Bringer of War

TAROT: The Tower

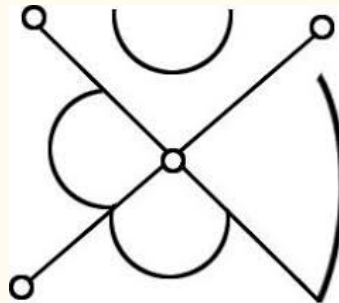
SEAL:

CHAKRA: Solar Plexus

METAL: Iron

STONE: Bloodstone, ruby, garnet

INCENSE: Dragons Blood, Cinnamon, hot chillies (only outdoors!),
coriander, coffee



Mercury- Wednesday

Hermes, draw near, and to my pray'r incline,
Angel of Jove, and Maia's son divine;
Prefect of contest, ruler of mankind,
With heart almighty, and a prudent mind.
Celestial messenger of various skill,
Whose pow'rful arts could watchful Argus kill.
With winged feet 'tis thine thro' air to course,
O friend of man, and prophet of discourse;
Great life-supporter, to rejoice is thine
In arts gymnastic, and in fraud divine.
With pow'r endu'd all language to explain,
Of care the loos'ner, and the source of gain.
Whose hand contains of blameless peace the rod,
Corucian, blessed, profitable God.
Of various speech, whose aid in works we find,
And in necessities to mortals kind.
Dire weapon of the tongue, which men revere,
Be present, Hermes, and thy suppliant hear;
Assist my works, conclude my life with peace,
Give graceful speech, and memory's increase.

GLYPH:



Mercurius

AURA: Bright Orange

TAROT: The Magician

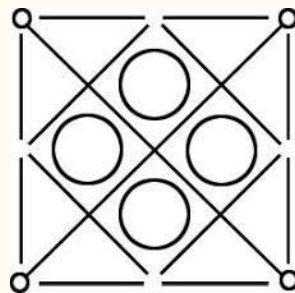
CHAKRA: Throat

CLOTH: Orange

CANDLES: Orange, 8

METAL: Mercury

PLANETARY SEAL:



INCENSE: Lavendar, Lemongrass, Frankincense

STONES: Moldavite, blue laced agate, Fluorite, green onyx

Thursday: Jupiter

O Jove, much-honour'd, Jove supremely great,
To thee our holy rites we consecrate,
Our pray'rs and expiations, king divine,
For all things to produce with ease thro' mind is
thine.
Hence mother Earth and mountains swelling high
Proceed from thee, the deep and all within the
sky.
Saturnian king, descending from above,
Magnanimous, commanding, sceptred Jove;
All-parent, principle and end of all,
Whose pow'r almighty shakes this earthly ball;
Ev'n Nature trembles at thy mighty nod,
Loud-sounding, arm'd with light'ning, thund'ring
God.
Source of abundance, purifying king,
O various-form'd, from whom all natures spring;
Propitious hear my pray'r, give blameless health,
With peace divine, and necessary wealth.

GLYPH:



Iupiter

AURA: Bright Blue

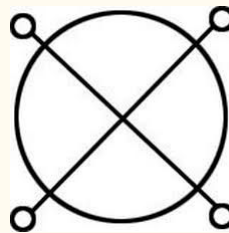
TAROT: The Emperor

CLOTH: Bright Blue

CANDLES: Bright Blue, 4

CHAKRA: Sacral

PLANETARY SEAL:



MUSIC: Holst, Jupiter, Bringer of
Jollity

STONES: Amethyst, Quartz, Topaz

INCENSE: Cedar, Sage, Nutmeg,
cloves, pine, copal

Venus- Friday

HEAV'NLY, illustrious, laughter-loving queen,

Sea-born, night-loving, of an awful mien;

Crafty, from whom necessity first came,

Producing, nightly, all-connecting dame:

Thine the world with harmony to join,

For all things spring from thee, O pow'r divine.

The triple Fates are rul'd by thy decree,

And all productions yield alike to thee:

Whatever the heav'ns, encircling all contain,

Earth fruit-producing, and the stormy main,

Thy sway confesses, and obeys thy nod,

Awful attendant of the brumal God:

Goddess of marriage, charming to the sight,

Mother of Loves, whom banquetings delight;

Source of persuasion, secret, fav'ring queen,

Illustrious born, apparent and unseen:

Spousal, lupercal, and to men inclin'd,

Prolific, most-desir'd, life-giving, kind:

Great sceptre-bearer of the Gods, 'tis thine,

Mortals in necessary bands to join;

And ev'ry tribe of savage monsters dire

In magic chains to bind, thro' mad desire.

Come, Cyprus-born, and to my pray'r incline,

Whether exalted in the heav'ns you shine,

Or pleas'd in Syria's temple to preside,

Or o'er th' Egyptian plains thy car to guide,

Fashion'd of gold; and near its sacred flood,

Fertile and fam'd to fix thy blest abode;

Or if rejoicing in the azure shores,

Near where the sea with foaming billows roars,

The circling choirs of mortals, thy delight,

Or beauteous nymphs, with eyes cerulean bright,

Pleas'd by the dusty banks renown'd of old,

To drive thy rapid, two-yok'd car of gold;

Or if in Cyprus with thy mother fair,

Where married females praise thee ev'ry year,

And beauteous virgins in the chorus join,

Adonis pure to sing and thee divine;

Come, all-attractive to my pray'r inclin'd,

For thee, I call, with holy, reverent mind

GLYPH:



Venus

AURA: Green

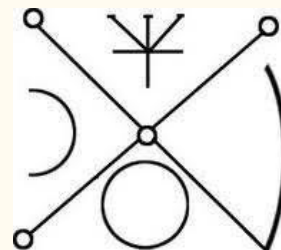
CLOTH: Green

CANDLES: Green, 7

TAROT: The Empress

CHAKRA: Heart

PLANETARY SEAL:



MUSIC: Holst, The Planets, Venus, Goddess of Love

STONES: Green Aventurine, Turquoise, Emerald, Diamond

INCENSE: Rose, Sandalwood, Musk

Herbs for Saturday: *Saturn Horesetail*

Saturn is related to **Karma**, and taking Saturnian **Spagyrics** can help to understand, absorb, transform and transcend the sometimes heavy lessons that life (Saturn) bring...and will keep bringing until YOU LEARN!

Learning the lessons of Saturn is sometimes hard, but when we do we can increase our sphere of potential, usually limited and constricted by Saturn and expand it, leaving room for more...

Horsetail: contains large amount of minerals, especially silica. Particularly useful for treating malnutrition-related diseases, which can manifest in/as poor skin, fingernails, hair etc.

Horsetail increases calcium absorption, making it particularly good for bones, osteoporosis, arthritis, and teeth, as well as helping to repair connective tissue damage. It aids in the quickening of wound healing, applied externally, or taken internally..

Horsetail has been used to treat Alzheimer's and other age-related diseases. It's good for circulation generally, as well as inflammation. It can alleviate kidney stones, obesity and sinus issues.

Psychologically, **Horsetail** can treat phobias, repression, compulsive behaviours such as OCD.



Herbs for Saturn

Herbs that are cooling, constricting, drying, and stabilizing

Herbs that affect the spleen and body structure, like bones and their weaknesses, like arthritis

Herbs that affect slow processes, like ageing

Poisonous herbs

Herbs that are deliriants or hypnotics

Herbs that are cooling, constricting, drying, and stabilizing

Herbs that rejuvenate or that affect ageing

Shrubs and hard or woody plants (because Saturn is cold and dry)

Plants that like to grow in cold and dry locations, like mountains

Plants with wispy, pale flowers

Plants that grow in crevices

Plants that produce a lot of seeds

Invasive plants (teach us to know our boundaries)

Slow-growing plants, because Saturn is slow
Cooling plants

Plants that like shade or have deep roots
(coolness again)

Medicinal plants that affect the bones, muscles and teeth

More shrinking and drying than Venus
astringents

Herbs that help with phobias and OCD

Rules

Excretory system

ulcers or hypertension

Phobias and OCD



Herb for Sunday: Sun: Rosemary (Rosemarinus Officinalis)

The **Sun** stands for the Self. It is Tipareth on the Tree of Life- the Sphere of our True Selves.

The **Sun** rules self confidence, charisma and vitality.

It rules the heart, and overall well being. The **Sun's** energy brings warmth, radiance, energy and positivity.

Negatively placed, we become egotistical, self centered and narcissistic.

Rosemary brings all of the positive qualities of the **Sun**. It's great for depression and sadness.

Its antiviral, antibacterial, antispasmodic, anti-inflammatory and is full of antioxidants.

It helps the heart, and improves circulation. It can help to control blood pressure problems.



Herbs for the SUN

Plants resembling the sun in shape and color

Plants that open to the sun and close at night

Herbs affecting the heart

Warming, relaxing herbs

Rules

Circulatory system

Heart

Blood

Eyes

Right eye

Upper back

Spleen

Spinal column

Thoracic spine

For: Heart disease

Allergy

Dermatitis

Skin Cancer

Sunstroke

Fever

Heart Attack

Radiation poisoning

Photophobia

Chills

Hot flashes



Herb for Monday: *Moon: Maca (Lepidium meyenii)*

The energies of the *Moon* are deep and changeable, like the tides and the phases She passes through throughout the month.

Moon energy is feminine in nature, and mysterious. She rules the realm of psychic perception, dreaming, and the Astral Realms.

She rules the emotions, and the cycles of growth and decay.

Her's are the Feminine Mysteries, including menstruation, fertility and menopause.

When we attune to the *Moon*, we attune ourselves to the natural rhythms and cycles of life.



Out of balance, we become over emotional, unable to tell what is our own or others 'stuff', irrational, unreliable and distant.

Maca, from high in the Andes is considered a super-food and wonder-tonic. There are many varieties to choose from. They say in the Andes that red and black are best for men, and white for women. Each contains are a high number of vitamins and minerals, including vit b,e,c as well as high levels of calcium, iodine, magnesium, potassium, zinc.

It's also packed full of amino acids, carbohydrates and fatty acids. It balances the hormones, energy, stamina, and sexual energy in both men and women.

Its good for hormonal balance pre and post menopause, and can raise the sperm count in men. Its an anti-depressant too, as well as lowering blood pressure.

Psychologically, it aids in adapting to change and stress, and helps to heal deep seated emotional issues. It helps awaken and tap into our psychic gifts and powers, and the Dreaming.

Herbs for the Moon

Sedative Herbs

Hormone-balancing Herbs

Herbs for the brain or stomach

Narcotic or pain killing plants

Cooling and moisturizing plants

Plants with moon-shaped parts

Plants with high water content

Plants that live in or near the water

Herbs affecting the emotions

Herbs for sleep and dreaming

Herbs affecting the female reproductive system

Rules

Lymphatic system

Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD

PMS,

Structural brain problems, like tumors, cysts and lesions



Herb for Tuesday: *Mars: Nettle (Urtica Dioica)*

Mars energy gives us our drive, our passion, our 'warriorship'. It gives us determination and courage. It strengthens the immune system.

Out of balance, however, it can lead to anger issues, violence and stress, leading to weak immunity, ulcers and diseases of the blood.

Nettle helps to balance these energies. *Nettle* contains high amounts of trace elements, including iron, calcium, potassium and silicon.

Nettle stimulates our ability to let go- elimination of all that is unnecessary, including toxins.

Nettle is a master blood cleanser, and has strong anti-inflammatory properties, helping with gout, rheumatism and arthritis as well as other inflammatory diseases. It reduces acidity in the body and alkalises the blood (slightly), as well as reducing blood pressure overall. This relieves pressure on the heart and can help heal heart related diseases. As a result of its iron and blood building properties, *nettle* can heal anemia, dizziness and malabsorption.

It stimulates the immune system and can help kidney, liver and menopause related symptoms.

On a psychological level, *Nettle* teaches right use of power, courage and will.



Herbs for Mars

Plants with thorns or prickles

Plants with a strong, spicy taste

Herbs that purify the blood

Herbs that help the head

Herbs for sexual potency

Heating plants

Rules

Muscular system

Blood, Bile, Gallbladder

Adrenal glands

Tendons

Genitals

Arteries

Head, Face

Basic energy, physical strength & vitality

Injuries, accidents

Blood or immune disorders

Will, drive and force

Sex drives

Competitiveness

Activity

Fevers, rashes, infections, stress, aggression, ulcers and hypertension



Herb for Wednesday: *Mercury: Lavender (Lavandula Angustifolia)*

Mercury rules communication, cleverness, speech, mind and its ideas. It rules the breath and the connections between the different aspects of our being (Hermes, the Divine Messenger).

An out of balance *Mercurial* energy can manifest as sluggishness and heaviness, as dull wittedness, and as feeling stuck, unable to move, or communicate well with self, or others. Physically, this energy can manifest as brain and nervous system disorders.

Lavender is calming. It uplifts the spirit and can help with depression and mood disorders.

Lavender improves our mental outlook, as well as enhancing the Mind in all its facets.

Lavender improves our communication *and speech*.

It enhances the circulation to the peripheries, and can help with all nervous disorders, including stress, anxiety, panic attacks, general tension etc. Its good for headaches and migraines, and is a great cure for insomnia.

It has been used as a succesful treatment for diabetes and insulin production/resistsance.



Herbs for Mercury

Plants with fine or feathery leaves- to resemble the nervous system

Medicinal plants affecting the brain function, speech, thought, lungs, nervous system, or speech, especially those that quicken these functions

Herbs that increase intellectual capacity or memory

Fast-growing weeds, creepers, winding plants Herbs that combine well with other herbs

Herbs that are fleetingly aromatic; often have a licorice flavor

Herbs that affect the nervous system

Herbs that affect the electrical activity in the brain and body

Nervines or alternatives (balancing)

Rules

Brain & Nervous system

Mind and emotion

Respiratory system

Senses

Consciousness

Rational mind, basic mental processes

Communication



Herb for Thursday: *Jupiter: Lemon Balm (Melissa Officinalis)*

Jupiter rules expansiveness, joviality, spiritually, wealth and health, digestion and metabolism.

Out of balance, *Jupiterian* energy can lead to over-indulgence, poor judgment, bad digestion and assimilation, and problems with basic metabolism.

Lemon Balm can help to balance these energies. Considered by the Alchemists as a wonder drug, a universal panacea, made famous by Paracelsus, and the Ens.

Lemon Balm is anti-viral, antibiotic and antispasmodic.

It can be used to treat disorder of the thyroid and disorders of the nervous system, including Parkinson's.



Full of *Alchemical Fire* and life force, Melissa, is believed to be able to renew lost youth and vitality.

It strengthens the brain, and the memory.

At a psychological and spiritual level, *Melissa* expands and enhances one's connection with the All.

Herbs for *Jupiter*

Nutritious fruits like olives and figs,
and nuts

Aromatic plants

Medicinal plants affect the arteries or
liver

Often bright yellow and bitter (bile)

Plants that make one feel expansive,
relaxed, calm, warm but not sedated or
sleepy

Rules

Liver

Digestive system

Metabolism, anabolic
building processes of the body

Nourishment

Fatty tissues

Illnesses from poor judgment, like
alcoholism or anorexia



Herb for Friday: *Venus: Burdock Root (Arctium lappa)*

Venus stands for love, for beauty, for sensuality, fertility, femininity. Out of balance, however, *Venusian* energy can lead to escapism, depression, avoidance of worldly issues, and difficulty with controlling one's emotions. It can also lead to delusion, narcissism and sexual issues and problems,

Burdock balances *Venusian* energies.

An aphrodisiac, and treatment for sexual problems including impotence and fertility issues.

Burdock root is an excellent anti-inflammatory and blood purifier, detoxifying the blood, kidneys, liver.

Burdock can help with skin conditions, containing high amounts of anti-aging antioxidants.

Burdock can strengthen and tone the lining of the stomach, leading to improved digestion and assimilation.

Psychologically, , *Burdock* can help to detoxify negative emotions and to remove the veils that prevent us from knowing and experiencing true beauty in our lives



Herbs for Venus

Sweet-smelling and pretty flowers

Large, lush flowers with a powerful scent

Plants with red fruit

Plants with soft, furry leaves

Medicinal plants affecting the kidneys, urinary system

Beautifying plants

Mildly astringent plants

Plants as above that overwhelm the senses

Rules

Genitals

Kidneys

Urinary system

Sex, Puberty, Hormones

Facial skin ,

Bladder, Uterus, ovaries,
Testes, Prostate, Urinary
tract

Tongue



Primum Ens Melissa

A step up from *Spagyrics*, in terms of its healing power and initiatory potential, The *Primum Ens* are plant elixirs reduced back to its ‘first beginning’ or reformed back to its ‘original nature’- it’s *Prima Materia*.

Paracelsus states that the *Melissa* plant (lemon-balm) is ‘supra-celestial’ in nature, and doesn’t belong to any one planet, making it an overall panacea.

Rich in *magnesium chloride*, the *Ens of Melissa* is considered to be a superlative healing medicine. The texts speak of its ability to rejuvenate hair, teeth, nails, skin and general Life force (to be clear, they also speak about them falling out first!)

There are many recipes for its concoction, and in later courses, we will demonstrate its production. For now, here is a recipe for its manufacture.



Ens Melisa Recipe

1. Make half a pound (recipes differ) of **Potassium Carbonate- Tartar- pure carbonate of potash**. We call this Lye. This is a lot less complicated than it sounds. Burn a bunch or any hard wood to ashes. **Calcine**, as when making **Spagyrics**, then use the **Water** method, and **leach** your salts- the ‘potcarb’.
2. Spread a layer of these **Salts** on a glass tray. It will get scarred, due to its *very* caustic nature. Be extremely careful when handling this substance- it can eat through skin, eyes eyes. Where gloves and protective goggles and work carefully and slowly. Make not Haste!
3. Over the course of a week or so, in the early morning, the Pottash will absorb the **Fire** from the morning dew- **AngelWater, Oil of Tartar**. This is known as ‘**deliquescence**’. You’ll need about half a litre, so if you don’t have enough, carry on ‘pulling’ every morning- or strengthen the alkalinity of the **Lye**.
4. Filter this liquid. Pulp, mash, and place as many leaves of melissa as will fit in the liquid, seal, and leave in a warm place for 2 weeks, shaking daily.
5. Take out the leaves. DON’T use filter paper to do this, as the **ENS**, floating on top of the mixture, will be absorbed into the filter paper and lost. The **Angelwater** should be bright green- a saturated solution of **Tartar**
6. Add on top pure *dry* (*no water*) alcohol $\frac{2}{3}$ inches above the **AngelWater** and leave again for 24 hrs, until the alcohol is green. To ‘dry’ your alcohol, first make sure its 95% pure, (EverClear will work) and then add a small amount of potassium carbonate. As it absorbs the water, you’ll see the separation clearly and can use an oil separator to recover your now ‘dry’ alcohol. This drying of the alchol is v. important- or it can be a poison rather than a medicine you make...
7. Filter off this green alcohol, store, and replace with new alcohol. Again leave for 24 hours in a warm place, until it has absorbed all the ‘green’
8. Seperate from the **Angel water** and add to your first alcohol pull
9. **Distill**
10. Evaporate off the alcohol, gently
11. You will be left with a (tiny amount) of a syrupy green substance. This is the **ENS of Melissa**. It should be pure green. Take 3-5 drops in water.

Recommended Reading and Websites

'Real Alchemy'- Robert Bartlett

'The Path of Alchemy'- Mark Stavish

'Alchemy Rising- The Green Book'- Heliophilus

'Alchemy and Mysticism'- Alexander Roob

'Fulcanelli and the Alchemical Revival: the Man Behind the Mystery of the Cathedrals'- Genevieve Dubois

P.O.N. (Philosophers of Nature) papers- out of print but available on the net

'The Palace of the Phoenix: Discover Tarot and Alchemy'- Markus Katz

'The Emerald Tablet: Alchemy of Transformation'- Dennis William Hauck

'12 Keys of Basil Valentine'- Basil Valentine/ various translators

Websites

Alchemywebsite.com

AlchemyGuild.com

Alchemystudy.com

